2. Discuss the importance of reducing the epsilon parameter in achieving a higher reward (1pts)

- Reducing epsilon can be important since it controls the amount of exploration in Q Learning. With a higher epsilon the SmartCab will try random actions more frequently, while with a lower epsilon it's encouraged to use actions that can be more effective. If epsilon is reduced after sufficient training then the total reward is improved by allowing the SmartCab to take more efficient routes. However, reducing epsilon too early can prevent the SmartCab before it discovers better strategies, so a balance is needed between the two.

3. Run the "Smart_cab_brute_force.ipynb" and compare and discuss the results with the reinforcement learning results. (2pts)

- In the random action baseline, the cab reached 200 timestep limit and incurred 58 penalties without completing the task. Compared with the Q Learning, which learns from the rewards and penalties to improve its actions, random action selection is more inefficient and does not reliably complete the passenger drop off task.